

The Hydrosphere

1. The surface of the earth covered with water is approximately?

- (a) One-fourth
- (b) Half
- (c) Two-thirds
- (d) Three-fifth (3/5)

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Around 29% (29.1%) of the total surface Area of the Earth is land (about 148172000 sq. km) and 71% part (70.9%) is covered by Ocean. Earth's surface covers with water in both liquid and frozen form. Hence, the surface of earth covered with water is approximately more than two-thirds of total surface area.

2. On the sea level, nearest place to the center of earth is?

- (a) North pole
- (b) Tropic of Capricorn
- (c) Tropic of Cancer
- (d) Tropic of Equator

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The nearest point to the centre of the Earth lie near Arctic Ocean (at the depth of 4 km from the surface) which is at the 6353 km far from the centre of the Earth.

3. A ridge of 64000 km. length and 2000 km to 2400 km width passing through the north and south Atlantic oceanic basin enter into the south pacific oceanic basin through Indian oceanic and then from the middle of Australia and Antarctic. This ridge is –

- (a) Socotra-Lakshadweep - Chagos-Ridge
- (b) Pacific - Antarctica Ridge
- (c) Dofin - Challenger Ridge
- (d) Mid - Oceanic Ridge

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

Above qualities are related to Mid Oceanic Ridge. Mid Oceanic Ridge encircles the globe in the length of approximately 40390 miles or 65000 kilometer, covering Arctic, Atlantic, Indian and the Pacific Oceans. This is the single largest geological phenomena upon the surface of Earth.

4. Where is 'Ninety East Ridge' situated?

- (a) Pacific Ocean
- (b) Indian Ocean
- (c) Atlantic Ocean
- (d) Arctic Ocean

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Ninety East Ridge (90° E Ridge) is the name of a ridge located in the Indian Ocean. Located near 90° east longitude (meridian), this ridge is 5000 km long parallel to it and stretched across 34° south latitude to 10° northern latitude with an average width of approx 200 km.

The Ocean Currents

1. Gulf Stream is –

- (a) a river in the Gulf
- (b) an oceanic current
- (c) another name of Jet Stream
- (d) a surface wind

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

Gulf stream is a powerful warm current in the North Atlantic Ocean. It originates at the Gulf of Mexico as the Florida current which merges in Antilles current and flows through the Cape Hatteras and then flows along the east coast of United States of America. Spanish explorer Juan Ponce de Leon first discovered the Gulf Stream in 1513.

2. Which one of the following is not an area of Mediterranean type of climate?

- (a) Central California
- (b) Northern New Zealand
- (c) Central Chile
- (d) Southern tip of Africa
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (b)

Northern New Zealand does not have a mediterranean type of climate because it experience a different climate pattern known as a temperate maritime climate. This climate is influenced by the surrounding ocean, which moderates temperatures and leads to relatively mild winters and summers without the distinct dry summers characteristic of Mediterranean Climates.

3. Cold water current flowing along Namibian Coast is known as

- (a) Agulhas Current
- (b) Benguela Current
- (c) Humboldt Current
- (d) Kuroshio Current
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)